Informative images

How to write text descriptions for images that communicate information, convey a mood, or add to the user experience.

Part of: **How to write text descriptions (alt text) in BBC News articles**

Contributors



Published on 30 May 2024

Contents

What are informative images?

Example

What are informative images?

This type of image communicates information, conveys a mood, or adds to the user experience in some way.

Examples include photos of people, scenery, or objects that are closely related to the content, even if they're not directly discussed within the piece.

There may be overlap between informative images and decorative images. The more relevant the image is to the story, the more likely it's an informative image.

Back to top

Example

Related to the story

Source: **Charles Bronson shows signs of PTSD, parole panel told**



Original text description: "A court sketch of prisoner Charles Bronson shows him in black suit and tie, wearing a white shirt".

This is a useful description (and yes, it is helpful to include colours).

Recommended text description: "A court sketch of a shaven headed Charles Bronson in dark glasses wearing a black suit and tie sitting at a table with a drink in front of him".

This conveys the right amount of detail and context.

Back to top

How to write text descriptions (alt text) in BBC News articles

About text descriptions

Decorative images

Informative images

Functional images

Images of text

Complex images

Describing people

Captions vs text descriptions

A final checklist

See all

Explore the BBC

Home

News

Sport

Business

Technology

Health

Culture

Arts

Travel

Earth

Audio

Video

Live

Terms of Use
About the BBC
Privacy Policy
Cookies
Accessibility Help
Parental Guidance
Contact the BBC
BBC emails for you
Advertise with us

Copyright © 2026 BBC. The BBC is not responsible for the content of external sites. **Read about our approach to external linking.**